INCH-POUND

A-A-20210
May 2, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SALSA

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers salsa, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The salsa shall conform to the types, styles, and formulations in the following list which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types, styles, and formulations.

Type I - Mild
Type II - Medium
Type III - Hot

Style A - Regular - The salsa shall be of a uniform diced texture with dices of no less than 3/8 inch (0.95 cm) cube and no more than 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) cube for the tomatoes and 1/4 inch (0.64 cm) to 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) dice for onions. There shall be no excess liquid media or weeping. Salsa shall meet a 30 second timed Bostwick of between 3.0 to 5.5 for consistency with no chunks blocking the gates.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8950

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Style B - Chunky - The salsa shall be of a uniform diced texture of no less than 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) cube and no more than 3/4 inch (1.90 cm) cube for the tomatoes and 1/4 inch (0.64 cm) to 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) dice for onions. There shall be no excess liquid media or weeping. Salsa shall meet a 30 second timed Bostwick of between 2.0 to 5.5 for consistency with no chunks blocking the gates.

Formulation 1 - Each type of salsa shall consist of peeled tomatoes, tomato puree, fresh or dried onions, fresh green chili peppers, and fresh jalapenos properly ripened and wholesome. Spices and condiments added shall include: no more than 1.5 percent salt; vinegar or citric acid added to adjust pH between 3.8 - 4.2; and any mixture of green peppers, cilantro, cumin, corriander, xanthan gum, flavoring, or modified starch. The pungency of the Type I salsa for this formulation shall be no more than 32 ppm of capsaicin, or 480 Scoville units. The brix level of the finished salsa media shall be 8 to 10 degrees with a 1.0 percent adjustment for salt content, with no individual sample below 7.5 degrees.

Formulation 2 - Each type of salsa shall consist of peeled tomatoes, tomato puree, or tomato paste; onions; green chili peppers or bell peppers; and jalapenos properly ripened and wholesome. Spices and condiments added shall include: no more than 1.8 percent salt; vinegar or citric acid added to adjust pH between 3.8 - 4.2; and any mixture of safe and suitable flavoring and thickening ingredients. The pungency of the Type I salsa for this formulation shall be no more than 0 to 5 ppm of capsaicin; Type II - greater than 5 ppm, but not more than 12 ppm of capsaicin; and Type III - greater than 12 ppm of capsaicin. The brix level of the finished salsa media shall be 8 to 11.5 degrees with a 1.0 percent adjustment for salt content, with no individual sample below 7.5 degrees.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Finished product:

3.1.1 Flavor and odor: Each formulation of salsa shall be free from off flavors, with no bitter, burnt, sour, or excessively hot taste. Each formulation of salsa shall be free from off odors.

3.1.2 Color: Each formulation of salsa shall have characteristic color, typical of salsa.

3.1.3 Age requirement: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the salsa shall not be over 90 days old at time of delivery.

3.1.4 Microbiological requirements: The microbiological standard for the finished salsa shall conform to the Food and Drug Administration standard for commercially sterile product.

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3.2 Analytical requirements: See formulations.

3.2.1 Analytical procedure: One four-ounce composited sample unit shall be submitted from each lot for testing.

3.2.2 Preparation of sample: The sample shall be prepared in accordance with the following Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International, Method 926.06.

3.2.3 Analytical testing: When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, analytical analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International or as shown below for commercial sterility as follows:

Test	Method
Pungency	995.03
Salt	935.47
pH	981.12
Commercial sterility	Food and Drug Administration Bacteriological Analytical Manual Chapter 21A, Section E.3 - Examination of acid foods (pH 4.6 and below) by cultivation

3.2.4 Test results: The test results for pungency shall be reported to the nearest Scoville unit and/or (ppm). Test results for salt shall be reported the nearest 0.1 percent and test results for pH shall be reported the nearest 0.1 unit. Test results for commercial sterility shall be reported to nearest number of colony forming units present per gram. Any result not conforming to the microbiological or analytical requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered salsa shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the salsa in the commercial marketplace. Delivered salsa shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The salsa provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same salsa offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Quality assurance. When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that salsa quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. Each formulation of salsa shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Type(s), Style(s), and Formulation(s) of product desired.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International and the Food and Drug Administration, Bacteriological Manual may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

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7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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